

HOLLIEBERRISEVENSISTERS4X4TOURSEDT

Travel Radio Australia and we are very honoured this month to have Holly Berry McQueen from Seven Sisters 4x4 Tours in Queensland and Holly Berry, welcome to the program. Hello, thank you for having me. I'm very grateful to be on.

Holly Berry, your tours are really incredible. Tell us first of all the region you're in in Queensland. You're north of Brisbane and tell us about the area you're from first.

My hometown is Agnes Water 1770 and it's a really beautiful place. It's surrounded by national parks, Yerramboola National Park and Deepwater National Park. There's a lot of sea life around there.

It's really good for fishing, it's great. It's the most northern beach on the east coast of Australia for surfing as well, so it brings in a lot of surfers. The wave there is really slow and long, so it's great for longboards and things like that.

It's not such a dynamic wave. There's scuba diving, there's snorkelling, it's just amazing. It's really pristine.

It's a very small town, maybe about four or five thousand people at the most. And explain the 1770 reference. Yes, it's Captain Cook's second landing place.

So he landed in Agnes Water at a place called Roundhill, which was named by him in 1770 on the 24th of May. So it's a very beautiful place. And the reason he pulled in there after pulling into Kernel in Sydney was because there was a freshwater spring there, so they could get some drinking water.

And the area, Bustard Bay, which is the big area on the creek side, as opposed to the ocean side. It's called Bustard Bay because they managed to hunt a bustard, which is actually a very rare bird for there. But they did get one bustard, so it was named Bustard Bay, even though there's hardly any there at all.

You run these four by four tours in the region. That must be very exciting to take people out. Tell us about the little areas that you take them to.

Well, I do day tours in Agnes Water, 1770. I do day tours in the school holidays, mostly when the tourists are in town. And yeah, they're really lovely tours as well.

You get to immerse in places around the area that you wouldn't ordinarily go in your own vehicle. Nice local spots. And then I also run 10 and 12 day overland trips.

So they are in Queensland. They're like Reef to Red Dirt. So they go from Wapa, which is the indigenous name for Great Keppel Island, traveling through all different country all the way out to

Longreach and Winton.

And then they hook back around to Magnetic Island as well. And then I might drop off that group of women. So my tours are actually, they're very niche.

They're for women that are 40 plus. So I'm a psychotherapist as well and a healer. And my business is 100% indigenous owned and operated, which is myself.

These tours were created because I've been listening to many, many people for over 18,000 clinical hours. And I've deduced that women over 40, moving into sort of 50s, they've often been in very long term caring roles. And then they pop out of these caring roles where the kids might've left home or they might've separated or they've just got time on their hands and they're wondering who they are.

So they pop out of these roles and it's like, whoa, what do I want to do with my life? I've got all this time. So these tours are healing tours. They're not just sightseeing and fun things.

They are very fun, but they're also culture and country. So I hook up with a lot of different mobs around as well, which is really lovely. So we get to sit with women on country and we do all different things.

So a bit of ceremony and going to different places that they choose to show us or maybe a bit of painting. And it's always a little bit different. It depends.

And I like that fluidity of it. I like that natural rawness of it. You know, we might go out and Winton is a beautiful town in the Outback and it's a dark sky town.

I don't know if you know Winton, but it's a dark sky town, which I love. So basically what that means is it means very, very low lighting in the night, which means you can see the amazing stars. And my company name, Seven Sisters, is actually a song line that runs through the country of Australia.

So it's also a constellation that we travel under, which is also known as Pleiades. And I also called it Seven Sisters because there's seven women that can fit in my Toyota Land Cruiser called Bumper. So Seven Sisters is a very apt name for me.

It has a lot of connection. I especially like Magnetic Island. I've been there myself and I was there on a beautiful sunny day when there were thousands of butterflies.

And that is just incredible experience. And I've been out to the Outback with Aboriginal trackers in New South Wales that sort of experience where you have the amazing billion star sky and it is tremendous. And I can imagine in Queensland, because it is so remote there, it just must be mesmerising.

I find Queensland a very powerful place. I really love Queensland and I've done a lot of touring myself. So this company that I've developed is honestly me.

I'm not trying to create a company. It's like the company created, it's very naturally come around. So all the skills that I have have been wrapped into these tours.

So I'm a psychotherapist and a healer and a tour guide. And I've been doing tour guiding on and off for 30 years. So it is very powerful.

And a lot of the places we go to are intently visited for that purpose. So I'm very deeply spiritual. And these tours are very, very niche and they're very much directed at women that want to ignite their soul.

They are completely transformational. I don't want a woman to leave the same way they came. I want them to be completely different.

I want it to be life changing, but it's up to each woman where they're at, what they want, how they want to change. But it's definitely facilitated in a cultural way, especially sitting with women on country, Indigenous women, Aboriginal women on country. It is a very powerful, powerful process and it's just humbling.

It's humbling learning and seeing the animals and the wildlife and the stars and just noticing, helping the women to be present, to notice when the wind changes, to feel the wind come from a different direction. That happens all the time, but no one notices it, right? So just getting really present. Yeah, we all get tied up in our urban lives and forget all this amazing stuff that just is on our doorstep here in Australia, that a lot of people travel the whole world to see and we don't do it ourselves.

It's really just right there. That's the thing. I have always done it.

My children have been raised, I've got three children and my children now are 20, 17 and 15 and they'd be completely be able to sustain themselves in the Outback. They've been taught many, many things on our family trips. So doing these Overland Tours is so lovely to have this idea and it's such a rare thing.

It's such a beautiful thing. I'm really excited about it. I'm just starting out in this realm of encapsulating all of my skills in the one basket, so to speak, in Thump of the Cruiser, I should say, and heading out there into the Outback with these wild women that are ready to transform and break out into their true selves and ignite their soul.

So very spiritual, spirited adventure. Toyota Land Cruiser is what you really need out there and I suppose you've had occasional where little things have gone wrong and you've had to fix things yourself and they're pretty reliable machines though, aren't they? Yeah, they are and they're very

comfortable. I've got a 200 series, so they're really comfortable.

So that's the best thing. I did a tour not long ago myself. I was in the back in Arnhem Land and it was a Troopy and it was the most uncomfortable thing I've ever done.

So the 200 series is a winner. You just wanted to get back to Thumper. Thank you so much for having me today.

I am really grateful. It's very lovely to be here and to meet you. So thank you so much.

I hope to see you again. Holly Berry McQueen from Seven Sisters 4x4 Tours. What's your website so people can get onto you there? My website is the number 7sisters4x4tours.com.au. It's been a pleasure.

Holly Berry, thanks for being on the program. Thank you.